

Creative Guide, Beta Testing & iOS App Launch

What to create, how many users you need,
and your exact path to the App Store.

5

Parts Covered

60+

Action Items

\$99

Cost to Launch

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1

App Store Creatives - What to Create

These are the assets Apple requires before submitting Couplix. Every item is mandatory.

1A - App Icon

The face of Couplix on every iPhone home screen and in the App Store

Size	1024 x 1024 pixels. Only this size is submitted - iOS creates all smaller versions automatically.
Format	PNG only. No JPEG, no SVG. No alpha channel. Background must be solid, not transparent.
Corners	Do NOT round corners. Apple adds rounding automatically. Submit a perfectly square icon.
Design	Your Couplix icon. Bold and readable at 60x60px (home screen size). Test by zooming out.
Background	Dark rich background - deep crimson or dark purple. Avoid plain white.
Export	Figma: Frame at 1024x1024, Export, PNG, 1x. Or export your SVG via Inkscape at this size.
Verify	Zoom to 60x60px and confirm the Split Heart icon is still clearly readable.

1B - App Preview Video

15-30 seconds, autoplays in the App Store, biggest conversion driver

The App Preview Video autoplays when someone browses your page. Done well it can double your download rate.

Duration	15-30 seconds max. Ideal: 18-24 seconds. No slow intros - hook the viewer immediately.
Size	1080 x 1920 pixels (9:16 vertical, same ratio as TikTok). H.264 encoding, MP4 or MOV format.
Sound	Muted by default. The video must make complete sense with NO audio. Add text captions to every key moment.
First 3 seconds	Your most emotional or striking moment. People decide in 3 seconds whether to keep watching.
Structure	0-4s: Hook. 4-12s: Fast feature highlights. 12-17s: Emotional moment. 17-20s: App name and slogan.
What NOT to show	No login screens, loading spinners, empty states, or error messages. Show only best screens.

How to record

iOS Simulator, File, Record Screen. Edit in CapCut (free) or iMovie. Export at 1080x1920.

1C - App Store Screenshots (5-7 images)

Your visual pitch - the most-seen asset on your App Store page

Screenshots are marketing assets, not screen grabs. Each tells one part of the Couplix story.

Required iPhone sizes - Apple will reject without all three:

iPhone 6.7"	1290 x 2796 pixels. Required. Covers iPhone 15 Pro Max, 15 Plus, 14 Pro Max.
iPhone 6.5"	1242 x 2688 pixels. Required. Covers iPhone 14 Plus, 13 Pro Max, XS Max.
iPhone 5.5"	1242 x 2208 pixels. Required. Covers iPhone 8 Plus.

The 7 Screenshots - What Each Should Show:

- 1

Hero / Emotional Hook
1290x2796px
Most beautiful, emotional screen. Show a couple. Headline: Together is a feeling, not a place. First impression.
- 2

Shared Task List
1290x2796px
Both partner names with pink and purple progress dots. Dual-partner tick system. Headline: Shared goals. Both partners. One screen.
- 3

Daily Dare Feature
1290x2796px
Active dare card with three tier labels (Fun, Deep, Spicy). Headline: A new challenge, every single day.
- 4

Chat Linked to Tasks
1290x2796px
Chat message appearing right after a task is ticked. Headline: Complete it. Talk about it.
- 5

Daily Photo Snap
1290x2796px
Two partner photos side-by-side for the same day. Headline: Your day. Their world. One shared feed.
- 6

Long Distance Mode
1290x2796px
Countdown timer to next visit and mood sync dial. Headline: Every hour, a little closer.
- 7

Question of the Day
1290x2796px
Both partner answers revealed side by side. Headline: 500+ questions to know each other deeper.

Device frames

Add a phone frame. Use Previewed.app or AppMockUp.com (both have free tiers). Essential for professionalism.

Caption text	Bold headline (6 words max) at top and short supporting line below. White text on dark bar works reliably.
Background	Dark gradient (purple to pink) behind phone frame. Not plain white - it gets lost in the store.
Consistency	All 7 screenshots: same font, colours, caption style. Must feel like a designed set.

1D - App Description Copy

What users read when they tap to learn more on your App Store page

Promotional text	170 chars max. Shown above description. Suggested: Stay woven into each others day - dares, tasks, snaps, and daily presence. For every kind of couple.
Long description	Up to 4,000 chars. Lead with emotion (why Couplix exists), then list features in short paragraphs. Never one long block.
Keywords (iOS)	100 chars, comma-separated. Do not repeat words from app name. Suggested: couples,long distance,relationship,love,connection,partner,romance,intimacy,daily,bond
Category	Primary: Lifestyle. Secondary: Social Networking.
Age rating	4+ if no romantic content. 12+ if Spicy dares include suggestive content. When in doubt choose 12+.

2

Social Media Creatives

These assets build your audience before and after launch. Prioritise TikTok and Instagram. Create reusable templates.

TikTok / Instagram Reels

1080x1920px, 9:16, MP4, 15-60 seconds

What to create	Show real raw use of Couplix. Not polished ads. Best: "I sent my partner my heartbeat while they were at work - here is their reaction." Authentic emotion converts far better than production value.
Hook first 2 seconds	Open with your most striking moment. Never start with a logo. Show the app in action immediately.
Captions	85% of TikTok is watched with sound off. Add captions to every word. Use the platform auto-caption tool.
Frequency	Post 3-5 times per week. Consistency beats quality every time.
Best hashtags	couplesoftiktok, longdistancerelationship, coupleapp, couplesgoals, ldrlove

Instagram Feed Posts

1080x1080px (square) or 1080x1350px (portrait)

Template types	(1) Feature highlight: one feature, bold headline, screenshot. (2) Quote card: slogan on brand colours. (3) Use-case post for specific couple types.
How many	Create 5-10 templates in Canva or Figma. Fill them weekly. Consistency matters more than novelty.
Caption strategy	First line must hook - it is all that shows before more. Put App Store link in bio.

Instagram Stories

1080x1920px, 15 seconds per frame

What to post	Poll stickers, countdown to launch, behind-the-scenes clips, feature reveals, tester reactions.
Frequency	Post daily - even just one frame. Stories drive follows and DMs more than feed posts.
Highlights	Save to Highlights: Features, Beta, Reviews, Behind the Scenes. New visitors will watch these.

Product Hunt

240x240 logo, 1270x952 gallery images, 60 char tagline

What it is	A platform where tech users discover new products. A top-5 launch can drive 1,000-5,000 downloads in 24 hours.
Tagline	Suggested (60 chars): Daily rituals for couples wherever you are
Launch day	Launch at 12:01am PST on Tue/Wed/Thu. Line up 50+ people to upvote in the first 2 hours.

Share Card

1200x630px for link previews, 1024x512px for direct sharing

What it is	The image shown when someone shares your App Store link on WhatsApp, iMessage, or Twitter. Travels virally.
Content	Couplix icon, app name, slogan, one hero screenshot. Clean, readable at thumbnail size.
Technical	Set Open Graph meta tags on your landing page to control how this image appears when shared.

Content calendar for 4 weeks pre-launch: Week 1 - origin story on LinkedIn and Twitter. Week 2 - feature reveals one per day on TikTok and Reels. Week 3 - beta tester reactions. Week 4 - launch countdown. After launch: 3 posts per week minimum for 90 days.

3

Beta Testing - Users, Devices & Checklist

Couplix requires two people using it simultaneously. Individual testers cannot evaluate the full experience. You need actual couples.

How Many Beta Users Do You Need?

Exact numbers by phase

Phase	Couples	People	Who	Goal
Internal (now)	2-5	4-10	You and partner and close friends	Catch crashes and broken flows
Extended wk 2-3	10-20	20-40	Friends, family and partners	Real use, feedback, retention
Pre-launch wk 4	25-50	50-100	Wider network and public link	Scale, edge cases, devices
Min for Apple	10 couples	20+	3+ iPhone models required	Apple expects tested product

Which Devices Must You Test On?

iPhone SE (3rd gen)	Smallest current iPhone at 4.7". Many users still have SE models. Tests layout at minimum size.
iPhone 14 or 15	Your primary reference device. Most users will be in this range.
iPhone 15 Pro Max	Largest screen at 6.7". Tests layout at maximum size. Dynamic Island affects notifications.
iOS 16	Some users have not updated. Confirm core features work on iOS 16 minimum.
iOS 17 and 18	All features must work flawlessly on current iOS versions.
Mobile data 4G	Real-time sync and photo upload behave differently on mobile data vs WiFi. Test both.
Slow network	Simulate 3G. App must show error state, never crash or go blank.

Critical Tests - All Must Pass Before Submitting to Apple

Two strangers can pair in under 2 minutes

☐

Time it with someone unfamiliar. If longer, onboarding needs work.

Real-time task sync under 5 seconds on mobile data

☐

Partner ticks task - appears on other phone in under 5 seconds on 4G.

☐**All push notification types arrive within 30 seconds**

Test each type: message, Dare, Nudge, photo, mood change individually.

☐**Photo snapped, uploaded, and received with caption**

End-to-end on WiFi and 4G. Full resolution must arrive.

☐**App works after 24 hours of inactivity**

No stale data, no login loop, background processes still running.

☐**Crash-free rate above 99% confirmed in Sentry**

Do not submit with known crashes.

☐**Data isolated between different couples**

Couple A cannot see Couple B data. Test with two separate pairs.

☐**New user onboarded by someone unfamiliar**

Target: under 2 minutes. No guidance from you.

☐**All text readable on iPhone SE**

Nothing truncated or overflowing on smallest supported screen.

☐**App recovers gracefully from no network**

Must show clear error state, never blank screen or crash.

☐**5 real couples used for 5+ consecutive days**

Do they open it unprompted? Retention data is the real product test.

☐**iOS 16 and iOS 17+ both work correctly**

Test on older device or use Simulator with iOS 16.

The couples app testing trap: recruit real couple pairs, not individuals. A friend testing alone cannot evaluate real-time sync, the Nudge feature, or the photo receiving experience. The partner-sync IS the product.

When Are You Ready to Submit to Apple? - All 4 Required**1****Crash-free rate above 99%**

Confirmed in Sentry or Firebase Crashlytics. Do not submit with known crashes.

2**At least 10 couples tested for 7+ days**

Real retention data required. Day 7 retention is your product health signal.

3**All screenshots, video, and metadata ready**

Apple cannot review without these. Missing assets cause immediate rejection.

4

Privacy Policy live at a public URL

Apple checks this during review. Must be live and accurately describe Couplix data practices.

4

iOS App Store Launch - Step by Step

Follow these steps in exact order. Budget 3-5 days for the full process - most of that time is waiting for Apple.

Full Timeline - Plan for This Before You Start

#	Action	Time	Notes
1	Enroll in Apple Developer Program	24-48 hrs	Do this today. Approval can take 2 days. \$99/y...
2	Register App ID and App Store Connect r...	15 min	Bundle ID cannot be changed after first submis...
3	Confirm app.json config	5 min	bundleIdentifier, version, buildNumber must be ...
4	Run EAS production build	15-20 min	Runs in EAS cloud. Your machine can close.
5	Upload to App Store Connect	5-10 min	Use eas submit or Transporter app (free).
6	Apple processing	5-30 min	Status shows Processing. Wait for the email.
7	Complete submission form	30-60 min	Screenshots, description, rating, review notes.
8	Apple review	24-72 hrs	First submissions can take up to 7 days.
9	Manual release	When ready	Set Manual Release so you control the exact m...
10	Worldwide propagation	1-2 hrs	App Store link goes live globally after release.

STEP 1 - Enroll in Apple Developer Program

The only mandatory cost. Do this today - approval takes 24-48 hours.

URL	developer.apple.com/programs/enroll
Account type	Individual (for solo developers, not Organisation)
Cost	\$99 USD per year. Covers TestFlight, App Store, and all distribution.
Approval	24-48 hours. Apple may verify identity by email.
Do this now	Waiting adds days to your timeline. Enroll before you are ready to submit.

STEP 2 - Register Your App ID

The App ID uniquely identifies Couplix. It must match app.json exactly.

Where	developer.apple.com, Certificates IDs and Profiles, Identifiers, +
Bundle ID	com.yourname.couplix - must match app.json bundleIdentifier character for character
Capabilities	Enable Push Notifications. Enable Background Modes if needed.
Warning	Bundle ID cannot be changed after first App Store submission. Choose carefully.

STEP 3 - Create App Record in App Store Connect

App Store Connect is where you manage your listing, builds, and TestFlight testers.

URL	appstoreconnect.apple.com - sign in with Apple ID
Path	My Apps, +, New App, iOS
App name	Couplix
Bundle ID	Select the App ID you just registered
SKU	Any unique internal string: couplix-001. Users never see this.

STEP 4 - Confirm app.json Before Building

Verify every field before running the build. Wrong values mean a rejected upload.

name	"Couplix"
bundleIdentifier	"com.yourname.couplix" - must match Apple App ID exactly
version	"1.0.0" for first submission
buildNumber	"1" - increment every new build you upload: 1, 2, 3...
orientation	"portrait" - couples apps are portrait only

STEP 5 - Run the Production Build via EAS

EAS builds your iOS app in the cloud. No Xcode installation required.

Install CLI	npm install -g eas-cli
Login	eas login (your Expo account, different from your Apple ID)
Configure	eas build:configure (run once, creates eas.json)
Build	eas build --platform ios --profile production

Duration	15-20 minutes. Check at expo.dev/accounts/username/builds
Certificates	EAS creates and manages your iOS certificates automatically on first run.

STEP 6 - Upload to App Store Connect

Once the build completes, push it to Apple.

EAS submit (recommended)	<code>eas submit --platform ios</code> - uploads directly, prompts for Apple credentials
Manual option	Download .ipa from EAS, open Transporter (free Mac app), drag in, Deliver
After uploading	App Store Connect, TestFlight, iOS Builds. Status shows Processing.
Export compliance	Apple will ask: select Yes, standard HTTPS/TLS encryption only.

STEP 7 - Complete the Submission Form

Fill in every field under Prepare for Submission in App Store Connect.

Screenshots	Upload for all required iPhone sizes with device frames and caption text.
App Preview Video	Upload your 18-30 second MP4 video.
Metadata	Promotional text, long description, keywords, category, age rating.
Review notes CRITICAL	Write: This app requires two accounts. Account 1: email/password. Account 2: email/password. Pair using the code shown on the onboarding screen. Without this Apple cannot test the app and will reject it.
Privacy Policy URL	Your live public privacy policy web page.
Release type	Set to Manual Release. Never choose Automatic.

STEP 8 - Survive Apple Review

Apple reviews every app before it goes live. First submissions take 24-72 hours.

Rejection 1	Missing demo account credentials. Always provide two working test accounts with pairing instructions.
Rejection 2	App crashes during review. Test on iPhone 14 Pro simulator before submitting.
Rejection 3	Privacy Policy URL is unreachable or inaccurate.
Rejection 4	Missing data type declarations in App Privacy section.
If rejected	Read the reason, fix only what is specified, resubmit within 24 hours. Second reviews are faster.

STEP 9 - Release Manually and Go Live

When Apple approves you receive an email. The app is NOT live automatically with Manual Release.

Where	App Store Connect, Your App, Pricing and Availability, Release Version
Phased rollout	Start at 7% of users then 100%. Catches critical bugs before full exposure.
Best timing	8-9am in your target market timezone on a Tuesday, Wednesday, or Thursday.
After release	App goes live worldwide within 1-2 hours.

Most important tip for Couplix: Apple reviewers test apps alone on a single device. They cannot test a couples app without a second account. If you do not provide two working test accounts and clear pairing instructions, the reviewer will reject citing incomplete functionality. This is the single most avoidable rejection for any paired social app.

5

Master Checklist - Print and Tick Off

Work through each section in order. This checklist covers everything from TestFlight to a live App Store listing.

App Store Creatives

- ☐ App icon exported at 1024x1024 PNG, no alpha channel
- ☐ Splash screen exported at 1284x2778 PNG
- ☐ App Preview Video recorded, edited, and ready 18-30 seconds
- ☐ Screenshots captured for all 7 key feature screens
- ☐ Device frames added to all screenshots
Previewed.app or AppMockUp.com
- ☐ Caption text overlaid on all screenshots
Bold headline plus short supporting line
- ☐ Screenshots exported for iPhone 6.7" at 1290x2796
Required
- ☐ Screenshots exported for iPhone 6.5" at 1242x2688
Required
- ☐ Screenshots exported for iPhone 5.5" at 1242x2208
Required
- ☐ App description written under 4000 chars
- ☐ Promotional text written under 170 chars
- ☐ Keywords compiled under 100 chars comma-separated
- ☐ Privacy Policy live at a public URL
- ☐ Terms of Use live at a public URL
- ☐ Landing page live with App Store download button

Social Media Creatives

- ☐ TikTok and Reels launch video filmed and edited
- ☐ 5 Instagram feed post templates created
- ☐ Instagram Story templates created
Poll, countdown, feature reveal
- ☐ Product Hunt listing prepared
Schedule night before, launch 12:01am PST
- ☐ Share card designed for link previews
1200x630px
- ☐ 50+ people confirmed to upvote Product Hunt on launch day
- ☐ Personal launch messages drafted for WhatsApp contacts
- ☐ LinkedIn founder post written
- ☐ Reddit posts drafted for r/LongDistance and r/SideProject

Beta Testing

- ☐ 10+ real couple pairs recruited to test on TestFlight
- ☐ All testers used the app for 7+ consecutive days
- ☐ App tested on iPhone SE, iPhone 14, iPhone 15 Pro Max
- ☐ App tested on iOS 16 and iOS 17+
- ☐ Crash-free rate confirmed above 99%
- ☐ All push notification types confirmed working
- ☐ Data isolation between different couples confirmed
- ☐ New user onboarding timed by unfamiliar user
Target: under 2 minutes
- ☐ App tested on slow network conditions
- ☐ Feedback collected from at least 5 couples
- ☐ All critical bugs fixed and re-tested

iOS App Store Submission

- ☐ Apple Developer Program enrolled at \$99 per year
- ☐ App ID registered in Apple Developer Portal
- ☐ App record created in App Store Connect
- ☐ app.json bundleIdentifier, version, buildNumber confirmed
- ☐ **Production build completed**
eas build --platform ios --profile production
- ☐ **Build uploaded**
eas submit --platform ios
- ☐ Export compliance answered: standard HTTPS encryption only
- ☐ All screenshots uploaded for all required sizes
- ☐ App Preview Video uploaded
- ☐ All metadata filled: description, keywords, category, age rating
- ☐ Two test accounts in App Review Notes with pairing steps
- ☐ Release type set to Manual Release not Automatic
- ☐ Submitted for Apple Review
- ☐ Apple approval email received
- ☐ **Released manually on chosen launch day**
8-9am Tue/Wed/Thu

You have built something real. Couplix is a genuine product solving a real emotional need for couples. The App Store launch process is detailed but entirely achievable. Follow each step in order, budget 3-5 days, and you will have a live app people can download.

Together is a feeling, not a place. - Couplix